Croar Payroll vs RazorpayX Payroll

Feature comparison and gap analysis

RazorpayX Payroll is a fully-managed, India-statutory, bank-integrated payroll SaaS. Its core commercial value is automated statutory compliance filing and actual salary disbursement. Croar Payroll is a well-architected payroll engine and approval workflow: it owns the correctness-critical core (salary structures, calculation, lifecycle, statutory deductions, payslips, RBAC) but not yet the managed-service layer (real money movement, government filing, attendance, self-service).

1. What Croar already has (parity with RazorpayX)

Area	RazorpayX Payroll	Croar (your app)
Multi-company	Org-scoped data	company_id on every row; all queries scoped
Employees	Add / edit / exit	Full CRUD, unique email/company, soft-delete keeps history
Salary structure	CTC -> component breakup	Array earnings/deductions; fixed or percent-of lines
Run payroll	Monthly run + preview	Cycle create + idempotent run; roll-up totals
Approvals	Review -> approve -> pay	Guarded state machine DRAFT->PROCESSING->APPROVED->PAID
Loss of Pay	Attendance-driven LOP	LOP days with 30-day pro-ration
Payslips	Auto-generated, downloadable	Immutable snapshot; PDF; released only when PAID
Email payslips	Auto-email	SMTP send_payslip_email
Statutory PF/ESI/PT	Auto-computed	EPF+EPS, ESI, PT slabs; versioned snapshot
Roles / access	Admin, maker-checker	RBAC ADMIN/HR/VIEWER -> payroll:* perms, API+UI
Dashboard	Org overview	Coverage, cycle status, disbursed vs pending

Note: Croar's engineering core is clean - pure Decimal payslip math, a statutory ruleset version snapshotted onto each historical payslip, and soft-delete everywhere. That is the hard, correctness-critical part and it is solidly built.

2. What is missing vs RazorpayX Payroll

1. Money movement (biggest gap)

RazorpayX's headline feature is actually disbursing salaries via bank/UPI/IMPS/NEFT. Croar's PAID status is a workflow flag - there is no bank account, payout API, or transaction reconciliation. This is what makes RazorpayX 'payroll' vs a payslip generator.

2. TDS / Income Tax

Explicitly deferred in statutory.py (Phase 2). RazorpayX does full TDS - annual projection, old vs new regime, 80C/declarations, Form 16, Form 24Q. Currently absent.

3. Automated compliance filing

RazorpayX auto-files PF (ECR), ESI, PT and TDS challans with government portals. Croar computes the amounts but has no challan generation, return filing, or portal integration.

4. Attendance & Leave management

Croar's LOP is a manual number on the structure. RazorpayX has leave types, balances, approvals and holiday calendars that feed LOP automatically. No attendance module here.

5. Employee self-service portal

RazorpayX gives each employee a login to view payslips, submit tax declarations, download Form 16, apply for leave and reimbursements. Croar's VIEWER role is org-side; employees do not log in.

6. Reimbursements & flexible benefits

Claims, Flexible Benefit Plan (FBP) and expense reimbursements feeding payroll are not present.

7. Onboarding & contractor payments

RazorpayX handles onboarding flows and contractor/vendor payouts (TDS 194C/194J). Croar has employees only - no contractor payment path.

8. Integrations / ecosystem

Accounting sync (Zoho/Tally/QuickBooks), Slack/HRMS, insurance marketplace - none present (Celery/Redis is scaffolded but unused).

9. Reports & registers

Statutory registers, salary register exports, GL/journal entries for accounting - Croar has a dashboard but no exportable statutory/accounting reports.

10. Operational polish

No audit log/activity trail (who approved/paid, when); no per-run variable pay/bonus/arrears overrides (lines live on the structure, not the run); only a 30-day monthly basis although a PayFrequency enum exists.

3. Summary & suggested next steps

Croar has the payroll engine and workflow layer - the hard, correctness-critical core. What is missing is the managed-service layer that defines RazorpayX commercially: real bank disbursement, TDS/income-tax, automated government filing, attendance/leave, employee self-service, reimbursements and contractor payouts.

Highest-impact next steps, in order:

- **1. Per-run adjustments / bonuses / arrears**
  Override lines per cycle, not just on the structure.
- **2. TDS computation**

Annual projection, regime choice, Form 16/24Q.

- **3. Attendance -> LOP automation**
  Feed LOP from a leave/attendance module instead of manual entry.
- **4. Employee self-service portal**
  Per-employee login for payslips, declarations, leave.
- **5. Payout integration**
  Real bank/UPI disbursement - the largest effort.

The first three build directly on the existing clean engine; the last is a much larger integration effort.